

FIFA World Cup

The FIFA World Cup began in Uruguay in 1930. It was not played in 1942 or 1946 because of the Second World War and its aftermath. The competition expanded over time from 13 teams in 1930 to 48 teams in 2026.

FIFA World Cup editions, 1930 onward

Year	Host(s)	Teams	Winner	Runner-up	Third	Fourth / other semifinalist	Final
2026	Canada, Mexico and United States	48	Spain	Argentina	England	France	Spain 1-0 Argentina (a.e.t.)
2022	Qatar	32	Argentina	France	Croatia	Morocco	Argentina 3-3 France; 4-2 pens
2018	Russia	32	France	Croatia	Belgium	England	France 4-2 Croatia
2014	Brazil	32	Germany	Argentina	Netherlands	Brazil	Germany 1-0 Argentina (a.e.t.)

Year	Host(s)	Teams	Winner	Runner-up	Third	Fourth / other semifinalist	Final
2010	South Africa	32	<u>Spain</u>	Netherlands	Germany	Uruguay	Spain 1-0 Netherlands (a.e.t.)
2006	Germany	32	<u>Italy</u>	France	Germany	Portugal	Italy 1-1 France; 5-3 pens
2002	South Korea and Japan	32	<u>Brazil</u>	Germany	Türkiye	South Korea	Brazil 2-0 Germany
1998	France	32	<u>France</u>	Brazil	Croatia	Netherlands	France 3-0 Brazil
1994	United States	24	<u>Brazil</u>	Italy	Sweden	Bulgaria	Brazil 0-0 Italy; 3-2 pens
1990	Italy	24	<u>West Germany</u>	Argentina	Italy	England	West Germany 1-0 Argentina
1986	Mexico	24	<u>Argentina</u>	West Germany	France	Belgium	Argentina 3-2 West Germany

Year	Host(s)	Teams	Winner	Runner-up	Third	Fourth / other semifinalist	Final
1982	Spain	24	<u>Italy</u>	West Germany	Poland	France	Italy 3-1 West Germany
1978	Argentina	16	<u>Argentina</u>	Netherlands	Brazil	Italy	Argentina 3-1 Netherlands (a.e.t.)
1974	West Germany	16	<u>West Germany</u>	Netherlands	Poland	Brazil	West Germany 2-1 Netherlands
1970	Mexico	16	<u>Brazil</u>	Italy	West Germany	Uruguay	Brazil 4-1 Italy
1966	England	16	<u>England</u>	West Germany	Portugal	Soviet Union	England 4-2 West Germany (a.e.t.)
1962	Chile	16	<u>Brazil</u>	Czechoslovakia	Chile	Yugoslavia	Brazil 3-1 Czechoslovakia

Year	Host(s)	Teams	Winner	Runner-up	Third	Fourth / other semifinalist	Final
1958	Sweden	16	<u>Brazil</u>	Sweden	France	West Germany	Brazil 5-2 Sweden
1954	Switzerland	16	<u>West Germany</u>	Hungary	Austria	Uruguay	West Germany 3-2 Hungary
1950	Brazil	13	<u>Uruguay</u>	Brazil	Sweden	Spain	Uruguay 2-1 Brazil (final- group decider)
1938	France	15	<u>Italy</u>	Hungary	Brazil	Sweden	Italy 4-2 Hungary
1934	Italy	16	<u>Italy</u>	Czechoslovakia	Germany	Austria	Italy 2-1 Czechoslovakia (a.e.t.)
1930	Uruguay	13	<u>Uruguay</u>	Argentina	United States	Yugoslavia	Uruguay 4-2 Argentina

Champions by titles

Generated automatically from the edition table above. Totals group a nation with its sporting predecessor only where the source content does (Germany includes West Germany); every other name is counted as written.

Brazil	5
	
1958, 1962, 1970, 1994, 2002	
Italy	4
	
1934, 1938, 1982, 2006	
Germany (incl. West Germany)	4
	
1954, 1974, 1990, 2014	
Argentina	3
	
1978, 1986, 2022	
Uruguay	2
	
1930, 1950	
France	2
	
1998, 2018	
Spain	2
	
2010, 2026	
England	1
	
1966	

How it works

- National teams first play years of qualifying matches within their own confederation to win one of a limited number of finals places.

- The finals begin with a group stage, where each team plays the others in its group; the leading teams advance.
- From the round of 16 onward, it is a straight knockout: one defeat and a team is out.
- The two semifinal winners meet in the final to decide the champion.
- The tournament has expanded several times since 1930 - see "Format milestones" below for exactly when.



Format milestones

- **1930:** 13 teams played the first edition.
- **1950:** no single final was scheduled; the decisive final-group match between Uruguay and Brazil determined the champion.
- **1982:** the field expanded from 16 to 24 teams.
- **1998:** the field expanded to 32 teams.
- **2026:** the field expanded to 48 teams and was hosted by three countries for the first time.



Memorable moments

- Uruguay defeated Brazil in the decisive 1950 match at the Maracanã, a result remembered as the *Maracanazo*.
- Brazil's 1970 side became the first team to win three World Cups.
- Diego Maradona inspired Argentina in 1986.
- Croatia reached its first final in 2018.
- Argentina and France played a 3–3 final in 2022 before Argentina won the shoot-out.
- Spain won its second title in 2026.



Editorial notes

- The 1930 tournament did not include a third-place match. FIFA's historical ranking places the United States third and Yugoslavia fourth.
- The 1950 final positions came from a four-team final group rather than semifinals and a final.
- “Germany” totals conventionally include West Germany's results.

References & review

Status: verified

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